

1. Sixteen Japanese Phrases (20 marks)

Problem designed by Abhishek Dedhe

Given below is a list of 16 Japanese phrases along with their English translations, in random order.

*niko tamago, gohon kawa, hachihon gen, goko ringo, kyuhiki inu, goma pureto,
nihiki neko, rokumai enberopu, gohiki neko, rokumai pureto, nihon hashi, kyuhon kawa,
kyumai kitte, hachihiki ari, kyuko tama, rokuko tama*

*two eggs, five apples, five plates, two wildcats, nine balls, five rivers, nine rivers, nine dogs,
six envelopes, eight ants, nine postage stamps, two chopsticks, eight strings,
five wildcats, six plates, six balls*

Assignment 1 [Answer Booklet]: Match the translations.

Assignment 2 [Answer Booklet]: Given your current knowledge and that *tiger* translates to *tora* in Japanese, which of the following would be valid and why?

nihiki tora, niko tora, nihon tora, nimai tora

Assignment 3 [Answer Booklet]: Actually, none of the above four phrases are valid. Instead, you might expect to see *nito tora*. You might also see *nito zo* (*zo* = *elephant*), and *nito raion* (*raion* = *lion*).

Which of the following are correct/valid Japanese phrases? Provide the English translations for the correct ones. Note: *yajirushi* = *arrow*, *hachi* = *bee*.

hachimai hashi, rokuhon yajirushi, gohiki zo, niko ringo, hachiko hashi, goto neko

Notes: Japanese, also known as *Nihongo*, is an East Asian language spoken by about 126 million people, primarily in Japan, where it is the official language and national language. It is a member of the Japonic (or Japanese-Ryukyuan) language family, and its relation to other languages, such as Korean, is debated. Japanese has been grouped with language families such as Ainu and Austroasiatic, but none of these proposals has gained widespread acceptance. Japanese has no genetic relationship with Chinese, but it makes extensive use of Chinese characters, or *kanji*, in its writing system, and a large portion of its vocabulary is borrowed from Chinese.
